🌻 SHOWCASE

9 Dec 2025

Causal Mapping: the evaluator's engine room

Marshalling causal evidence at scale for Contribution Analysis and beyond.

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A Multi-Method Power Tool

Causal Mapping is not primarily an evaluation method; it is a way of identifying and organising causal claims in support of evaluative judgement.

It fits naturally with **Contribution Analysis (CA)**, while still adding value to other evidence-based frameworks.

- **Outcome Harvesting:** strengthen significance claims by mapping the precise causal chain from outcome back to intervention.
- **Realist Evaluation:** identify Context-Mechanism-Outcome (CMO) linkages mentioned by sources.
- **Theory of Change:** test pre-defined theories against hundreds of empirical "mini-theories" from stakeholders.
- **QuIP:** strengthen causal contribution claims through explicit, source-grounded chains.

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1 Link = 100 Claims

An arrow in a map can look simple (for example, *Training -> Knowledge*), but that single link can represent dozens or hundreds of auditable claims from different sources.

- It supports evidence density, not cherry-picked quotes.
- It lets evaluators “double-click” into the source basis for each link.
- It keeps every claim tied back to verbatim text.

Integrating causal mapping into Mayne's 6 Steps

1. Set out the Attribution Problem

Define the evaluation questions and the level of evidence required.

CM Win: Identifies all potential causal pathways mentioned in the data.

2. Develop the Theory of Change

Establish the logic of how the intervention is expected to lead to results.

CM Win: Reconstructs the empirical ToC from hundreds of stakeholder views.

3. Gather Evidence on the ToC

Collect existing and new evidence to populate the causal links.

CM Win: Catalogues and labels causal claims from texts systematically.

4. Assemble the Performance Story

Build the contribution narrative based on synthesised evidence.

CM Win: Synthesises individual claims into long, verifiable chains.

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5. Assess Alternative Explanations

Account for external influences and other drivers of observed change.

CM Win: Explicitly maps non-project influences mentioned by sources.

6. Revise and Strengthen

Refine the story based on gaps identified in the evidence base.

CM Win: Highlights weak links where evidence count is low.

Scalable qualitative analysis

When you move from 10 interviews to 200 reports, manual coding alone stops scaling.
Causal Mapping uses AI to automate extraction of verifiable evidence nuggets, so the evaluator can focus on judgement.

The evaluator's back office

Causal mapping handles identification, marshalling, and labelling of evidence so you can focus on final evaluative judgement.

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42 Projects completed

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Testimonial

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Call to action

> Ready to get started? Sign up now.

Alert

> **Heads up.** Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet. Check your settings before continuing.

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